

CAREER DEVELOPMENT



author

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Career Development

Career Development for College Students is a practical, student-friendly resource that guides learners through exploring majors, identifying strengths, researching career options, and building essential professional skills. Through real-world examples and hands-on activities, it helps students set goals, make informed decisions, and gain confidence as they plan their academic and career pathways. This book supports students in taking meaningful steps toward creating a purposeful and fulfilling future.



Monica D. Galvan

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Detailed Licensing

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

1: First Chapter

The goal of this course is to help you find a career that fits your personality, interests, and values, so that work doesn't just feel like work — it feels like purpose. Think about it this way: if you follow your passions and do something you genuinely enjoy, you'll never feel like you're "working." You'll be growing, contributing, and living with energy and meaning. But to reach that point, you need to start with self-discovery — learning what makes you unique, what excites you, and what you truly care about. Why Knowing Yourself Comes First Many people choose careers based on what others expect — family, friends, or society — instead of what actually makes them happy. But lasting satisfaction comes from choosing a path that aligns with your values, interests, and strengths. When you understand what motivates you, you can make choices that feel right, not just convenient.

In this chapter, you'll begin to uncover who you are through several interactive activities and assessments. These tools will help you reflect on your personality, preferences, and workplace style. You'll learn what types of environments bring out your best — and which ones might drain your energy.

- **Personality & Interest Assessments:** Discover how who you are connects to what you do. Tools like **Jung's Typology Test** and **Holland's Career Quiz** will help you see how your personality and interests align with different types of careers and work environments.
- **Values & Motivation Activities:** Through a assessments and exercises, you'll identify what really matters to you — whether that's creativity, helping others, financial stability, independence, or balance. Knowing your values will help you choose a career that feels meaningful, not just practical.
- **Character Strengths Exploration:** Using a **Inventories**, you'll uncover your top personal strengths — qualities like curiosity, kindness, leadership, or perseverance — and learn how they can become your biggest assets in your academic and career journey.



These activities aren't about putting you in a box — they're about helping you uncover your natural potential and start seeing the connections between who you are and the kind of work that will inspire you most.

Putting the Pieces Together

Once you've gathered insights about your personality, values, and strengths, you'll write a short reflection summarizing what you've learned about yourself. This will serve as your foundation for future topics in the class, where you'll start mapping out your goals and exploring specific career options that match who you are.

Remember, this process isn't about finding the *perfect* job right away — it's about learning to make thoughtful, confident decisions. Every bit of self-knowledge you gain will guide you toward a career that feels both meaningful and enjoyable.

A Note for You

Take a deep breath — you're not just taking a class; you're starting a journey to discover who you are and where you're headed. The more you learn about yourself now, the more intentional and exciting your future career will be.

Let's get started — because your future begins with *you*.



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2: Getting Started- Creating Your Career

Learning Objectives

- Apply the career exploration and planning process.
- Describe the stages of career development and identify the stage you are currently in.
- Identify and apply important factors related to mindset such as a positive mental outlook, self-confidence and the power of positive thinking.
- Differentiate between a job and a career.
- Brainstorm ideas for your personal and career vision.

Introduction

Did you know the U.S. Department of Labor recognizes **hundreds of different occupations**, and new ones are emerging all the time? Just think about some time ago, hardly anyone had heard of an influencer, an AI ethics specialist, or a TikTok creator or seller. The world of work is constantly evolving, which means your dream job might not even exist yet!

That's why it's perfectly okay if you don't know exactly what career you want right now. The goal of this course is to help you **discover your direction**, identify what you're passionate about, and start building a plan that connects your education to your future.

Career exploration is a process of discovery. It's exciting, creative, and sometimes surprising. Even students who think they already know what they want to do often find **new interests, backup options, or even entirely new dreams** through this process.

The Four Phases of Career Exploration

Career exploration can be planned in **four key phases**, each helping you answer an important question about your future.

Phase 1: Who Am I?

Before you can choose the right career, you need to understand yourself. This first phase is all about **self-discovery**—getting to know your interests, values, strengths, and skills.

In this unit, you'll complete several **career assessments** and reflection activities that will help you:

- Discover your **personality preferences** and how they relate to different career fields.
- Identify your **top values**, like creativity, independence, or helping others.
- Explore your **character strengths**—traits that make you unique, like leadership, curiosity, or perseverance.
- Recognize your **skills and talents** that can transfer across many jobs.

By understanding who you are, you'll gain the confidence to choose a career that fits—not one that just sounds good on paper.

Phase 2: What's Out There?

Once you know more about yourself, it's time to explore the world of work. This phase is about **research and discovery**.

You'll dive into:

- **Career databases and websites** to explore job titles, descriptions, and growth trends.
- **Networking activities** that connect you with professionals in fields that interest you.
- **Real-world experiences** like volunteering, job shadowing, or internships to test your interests.
- **Industry expectations**, including the education, skills, and experience employers look for.

The more you learn, the better prepared you'll be to make smart, informed decisions about your major, your college pathway, and your long-term career goals.

Phase 3: What Factors Might Affect My Choice?

Every career decision comes with practical considerations. This phase helps you think through real-world factors that can shape your path—and how to plan around them.

Here are some questions you'll explore:

- **Time:** How long will it take to reach your goal? Will you need more school, training, or certifications?
- **Finances:** How much will your education cost, and what is the earning potential in your field?
- **Location:** Where are most jobs in your field located? Would you need to move—or can you work remotely?
- **Lifestyle & Family:** How might your career choice impact your personal goals, relationships, or work-life balance?

By thinking critically and creatively, you'll learn how to overcome obstacles and design a path that works for *you*.

Phase 4: Where Do I Go From Here?

This phase turns your exploration into action! Now that you've identified your interests and priorities, it's time to create your **career and education plan**.

In this unit, you'll:

- Choose a **major** or academic focus that aligns with your career goals.
- Explore **degree and certificate options**, including transfer programs and technical pathways.
- Identify opportunities for **hands-on learning**—like internships, service learning, or campus leadership.
- Begin developing your **Student Educational Plan (SEP)** with your counselor or advisor.

Remember, you don't need to have everything figured out right now. The key is to stay curious and keep moving forward with purpose.



Career Exploration Is a Lifelong Journey

Career planning doesn't end when you pick a major—it's an **ongoing process**. As you grow and gain experience, your interests, values, and goals may evolve. That's normal!

The more you learn about yourself and your options, the more focused and confident you'll become.

Be open to new ideas, take risks, and stay flexible as the world of work continues to change. Your career journey is not just about finding a job—it's about finding **fulfillment, growth, and purpose** in what you do.

Reflection Questions

1. What excites you most about exploring different careers?
 2. What skills or personal strengths do you already have that could help you succeed in the workplace?
 3. How can learning more about yourself help you make better academic or career choices?
 4. What factors (like finances, location, or family) do you think might influence your career path?
 5. How can you stay flexible and open to new opportunities throughout your career journey?
-

Key Terms

- **Career Exploration** – The process of learning about yourself and the world of work to make informed career decisions.
 - **Values** – The principles or beliefs that guide what's most important to you.
 - **Transferable Skills** – Skills that can be applied across different jobs and industries.
 - **Networking** – Building connections with people who can provide information, support, or opportunities.
 - **Student Educational Plan (SEP)** – A personalized academic roadmap that connects your coursework to your career goals.
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- [1: Getting Started- Creating Your Career and Life Planning Vision](#) by Graciela Martinez and Elizabeth Shaker is licensed [CC BY 4.0](#).

2.1: Overview of Career and Life Planning

“The Department of Labor defines 840 occupations in its Standard Occupation Classification system¹—and new occupations are being created at an ever-faster rate. Just ten years ago, would anyone have imagined the job of a social media marketing specialist? How about the concept of a competitive chef? As new careers develop and old careers morph into almost unrecognizable versions of their original, it’s OK if you aren’t able to pinpoint exactly what occupation or career will be your lifetime passion. However, it is important to define as best you can what field you will want to develop your career in, because that will help dictate your major and your course selections.”

The process of career exploration can be a lot of fun, as it allows you to discover a world of possibilities. Even those students who have a pretty clear idea of what they want to do should go through this process because they will discover new options as backups and occasionally a new direction even more attractive than their original choice. The career exploration process involves four phases addressing four important questions:

- **Phase 1: Who Am I?**
- **Phase 2: What’s Out There?**
- **Phase 3: What Factors Might Affect My Choice?**
- **Phase 4: Where Do I Go From Here?**

Phase 1: Who Am I?

This phase involves getting to know who you are. Understanding who you really are—is the first step of career exploration. You will have the opportunity to engage in many different career assessments in Unit 2 to allow you to learn more about your values, character strengths, personality preferences, interests, skills, and abilities. Each assessment will help you gain a better understanding of who you are and where you may fit best in the world of work.

Phase 2: What's Out There?

Unit 3 addresses phase 2 which involves doing career research. Once you have taken time to research yourself and gain a stronger understanding of who you are, you can begin to explore what types of careers might be best suited to you. This phase involves online research, talking to professionals in the field and gaining hands on exposure through volunteer work, internship experience, and networking. This phase also includes researching industry expectations and understanding minimum qualifications for employment. The more information you gather and the more you learn about the world of work will help you make well-informed decisions about your future career.

Phase 3: What Factors Might Affect My Choice?

In phase 3, you will take time to explore factors that may affect your choice and start making some decisions. It is important to use your creative thinking skills to come up with alternative “right” answers to factors that may present an obstacle to pursuing the right career.

- **Timing.** How much time must I invest before I actually start making money in this career? Will I need to spend additional time in school? Is there a certification process that requires a specific amount of experience? If so, can I afford to wait?
- **Finances.** Will this career provide me with the kind of income I need in the short term and the security I’ll want in the longer term? What investment will I need to make to be successful in this field (education, tools, franchise fees, etc.)?
- **Location.** Does this career require me to relocate? Is the ideal location for this career somewhere I would like to live? Is it somewhere my family would like to live.
- **Family/personal.** How will this career affect my personal and family life? Do friends and family members who know me well feel strongly (for or against) about this career choice? How important is their input?

Taking time to research, these factors will help you with the decision making process and allow you to plan and prepare for your future. The decision making process will be discussed in detail in unit 4 along with internal and external factors that influence decision-making.

Phase 4: Where Do I Go From Here?

It may seem odd to be thinking about life after school if you are just getting started. But you will soon be making decisions about your future, and regardless of the direction you may choose, there is a lot you can do while still in college. You will need to focus

your studies by choosing a major. You should find opportunities to explore the careers that interest you. You can ensure that you are building the right kind of experience on which to base a successful career. These steps will make your dreams come to life and make them achievable. In Unit 4, the educational planning process will be introduced. You will take time to learn about the career certificate programs, associate degree, and transfer programs at COC and gain a good understanding of what program you'd like to pursue while developing your comprehensive student educational plan.

Keep in mind that deciding on and pursuing a career is an ongoing process. The more you learn about yourself and the career options that best suit you, the more you will need to fine-tune your career plan. Do not be afraid to consider new ideas. Keep an open mind, apply careful consideration as you narrow down your choices, and solidify your career plan. Career planning is exciting: learning about yourself and about career opportunities, and considering the factors that can affect your decision, should be a core part of your thoughts while in college.

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2.2: Career Development

See if you can remember a time in your childhood when you noticed somebody doing professional work. Maybe a nurse or doctor, dressed in a lab coat, was listening to your heartbeat. Maybe a worker at a construction site, decked in a hard hat, was operating noisy machinery. Maybe a cashier at the checkout line in a grocery store was busily scanning bar codes. Each day in your young life you could have seen a hundred people doing various jobs. Surely some of the experiences drew your interest and appealed to your imagination.

If you can recall any such times, those are moments from the beginning stage of your career development.

What exactly is career development? It's a lifelong process in which we become aware of, interested in, knowledgeable about, and skilled in a career. It's a key part of human development as our identity forms and our life unfolds.

Stages of Career Development

There are five main stages of career development. Each stage correlates with attitudes, behaviors, and relationships we all tend to have at that point and age. As we progress through each stage and reach the milestones identified, we prepare to move on to the next one.

Table 1.1 - Career Development Stages

Stage	Description
Growing	This is a time in early years (4–13 years old) when you begin to have a sense about the future. You begin to realize that your participation in the world is related to being able to do certain tasks and accomplish certain goals.
Exploring	This period begins when you are a teenager, and it extends into your mid-twenties. In this stage you find that you have specific interests and aptitudes. You are aware of your inclinations to perform and learn about some subjects more than others. You may try out jobs in your community or at your school. You may begin to explore a specific career. At this stage, you have some detailed “data points” about careers, which will guide you in certain directions.
Establishing	This period covers your mid-twenties through mid-forties. By now you are selecting or entering a field you consider suitable, and you are exploring job opportunities that will be stable. You are also looking for upward growth, so you may be thinking about an advanced degree.
Maintaining	This stage is typical for people in their mid-forties to mid-sixties. You may be in an upward pattern of learning new skills and staying engaged. But you might also be merely “coasting and cruising” or even feeling stagnant. You may be taking stock of what you’ve accomplished and where you still want to go.
Reinventing	In your mid-sixties, you are likely transitioning into retirement. But retirement in our technologically advanced world can be just the beginning of a new career or pursuit—a time when you can reinvent yourself. There are many new interests to pursue, including teaching others what you’ve learned, volunteering, starting online businesses, consulting, etc.

Keep in mind that your career development path is personal to you, and you may not fit neatly into the categories described above. Perhaps your socioeconomic background changes how you fit into the schema. Perhaps your physical and mental abilities affect

how you define the idea of a “career.” And for everyone, too, there are factors of chance that can’t be predicted or anticipated. You are unique, and your career path can only be developed by you.

Review the 5 Stages of Career Development listed in the table above and answer the questions below.

1. Which stage of career development do you feel you are in currently?
2. Provide the 2 descriptions you identify with the most from your career development stage.
3. What challenges are you facing now in your career development?
4. Where are you headed next in your career development path?

Setting Yourself Up for Career Success

There are many factors that contribute to career success, such as: hard work, motivation, attitude, grit, resilience and talent. All these factors are related to mindset. Your thoughts and ideas in your mind influence your belief about yourself and your abilities. This influence directly impacts your attitudes, behaviors and ultimately your performance. Your mind is a powerful tool and you can use it to your advantage or disadvantage. You are in control!

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2.3: Setting a Growth Mindset

Your mindset can help support a healthy career journey or it can be used to sabotage your efforts for success. Dr. Carol Dweck, a world-renowned Stanford University psychologist, conducted a research study with junior high students and presented them with puzzles to solve, ranging from easy to hard. She observed different attitudes in the students. Some gave up more easily and did not believe in themselves. Others continued to work hard despite mistakes and did not give up. She discovered that some people view their intelligence and abilities as something that is fixed where others viewed intelligence and abilities as something that can be developed. In Dr. Carol Dweck's book, [Mindset: The New Psychology of Success](#), she states:

not smart or talented. In the other world, failure is about not growing. Not reaching for things you value. It means you are not fulfilling your potential . . . In one world, effort is a bad thing. It's, like failure, means you are not smart or talented. If you were, you would not need effort. In the other world, effort is what makes you smart or talented.” (Dweck 15-16)

The illustration on the following page demonstrates the two mindsets. The *fixed* mindset views intelligence as static. The *growth* mindset views intelligence as something that can be developed. Review the illustration and ask yourself: “Which mindset do I generally practice in my everyday life?”

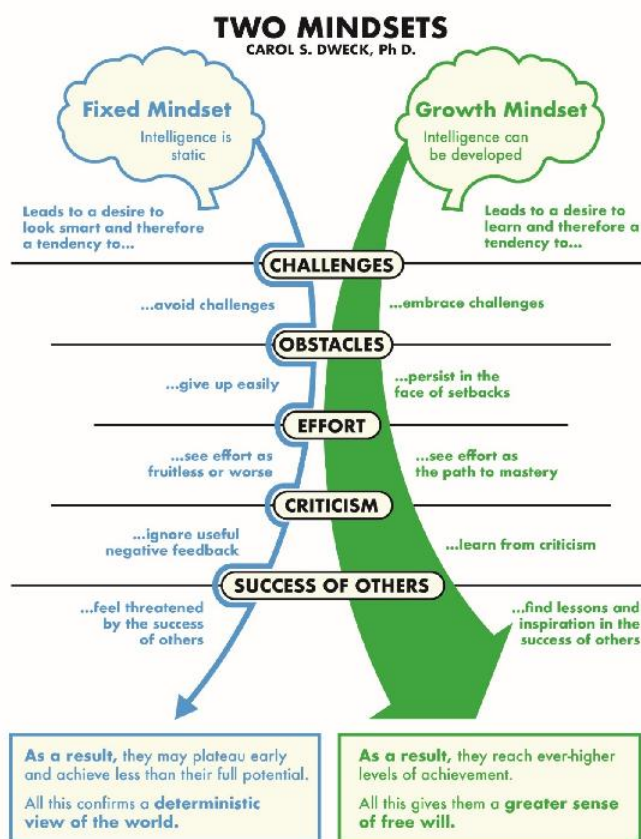


Figure 1.1 – Two Mindsets. (Image by [Ian Joslin](#) is licensed under [CC BY 4.0](#))

The Power Of “Yet” By Carol Dweck³

Carol Dweck is a professor at Stanford and the author of *Mindset*, a classic work on motivation and “growth mindset.” Her work is influential among educators and increasingly among business leaders as well. She researches “growth mindset” — the idea that we can grow our brain’s capacity to learn and to solve problems. In this talk, she describes two ways to think about a problem that’s slightly too hard for you to solve. Are you not smart enough to solve it ... or have you just not solved it yet?



The Power of Believing That You Can Improve.” (link: https://www.ted.com/talks/carol_dweck_the_power_of_believing_that_you_can_improve).

Your mindset can play an important role in your career and life planning process. As you prepare to answer the question, “Who Am I?” in Unit 2, we ask you to keep a *growth mindset* and practice the power of “yet” by Dr. Carol Dweck.

Grit⁴

, Grit is: firmness of mind or spirit; unyielding courage in the face of hardship or danger.

Passion and Perseverance or “Grit” by Angela Duckworth

Leaving a high-flying job in consulting, Angela Lee Duckworth took a job teaching math to seventh graders in a New York public school. She quickly realized that IQ wasn’t the only thing separating the successful students from those who struggled. Here, she explains her theory of “grit” as a predictor of success.



Grit: The Power of Passion and Perseverance.” (link: https://www.ted.com/talks/angela_lee_duckworth_grit_the_power_of_passion_and_perseverance).

After watching the videos, reflect on how you can apply a “*growth mindset*” and “*grit*” to your career and life-planning journey!

Affirmations

Positive self-talk improves self-image and allows for empowerment toward deliberate change. Affirmations are positive statements that describe a desired outcome and are often repeated until you start to believe them. Affirmations are directly related to mindset. As discussed earlier, your thoughts and ideas in your mind influence your belief about yourself and your abilities. This influence directly impacts your attitudes, behaviors and ultimately your performance. Be good to yourself and use affirmations to help build your confidence and belief in yourself.

Affirmations can be used to help raise self-confidence, control negative feelings and acquire new desired behaviors. They are particularly useful to help overcome negative thinking and self-sabotaging behaviors. Affirmations are intended to create new

possibilities.

For example, let's say I struggle with organization and often miss deadlines and this negatively impacts my performance at school and work.

My new desired behavior is to be organized and keep up with deadlines. To develop an affirmation for this desired new behavior there are a few things to keep in mind. When creating effective affirmations, it is necessary to:

- Phrase the affirmation in the present tense. For example:

I am organized and manage my time well.

vs.

I will be organized and manage my time well.

- Phrase the affirmation in the positive rather than the negative

I am productive and motivated.

vs.

I am not lazy and unmotivated.

Make sure the affirmation is believable and meaningful.

- Share your affirmations with others.
- Visualize success.
- Recite your affirmations daily.
- Repeat your affirmations when you start to engage in negative thought or behavior.

Here are some examples of positive affirmations:

- I practice a growth mindset.
- I am successful.
- I embrace challenges and view them as learning opportunities.
- I am strong and in control of my thoughts and behaviors.
- I am a valuable team player with a strong work ethic.
- I value hard work and put forth 100 % effort in all I do.
- I use my time wisely and complete assignments on time.
- I am mindful of how I spend my time and with whom.
- I practice a healthy lifestyle by eating well, exercising and forgiving myself when I make mistakes.

Using positive self-talk and repeating positive messages to yourself will help reinforce a positive self-image and will contribute to your career success! Take a moment and practice this.

Develop six affirmations related to being successful in your career and life planning. Be sure to state your affirmations in the present and use positive phrases. Make your affirmations personal and meaningful to you.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

Read your affirmations daily and modify them as needed. Practice them especially when you feel overwhelmed or discouraged. When you repeat your affirmations over and over, you will start to **believe** them and this will change your expectations, attitudes, behaviors and ultimately your performance.

Building Self-Confidence

Self-confidence plays an important role in many aspects of our lives. It is a key factor that contributes to success in school, work, home and in personal relationships with family and friends.

Many factors influence self-confidence. Some factors include environment, childhood upbringing, culture and experiences and interactions with others. These factors can help build confidence and strengthen our belief in ourselves and our abilities. Or they can minimize confidence and cause us to question ourselves and our abilities.

Eleanor Roosevelt once said, “No one can make you feel inferior without your consent.” This is a powerful statement because it emphasizes the control you have within yourself. Building self-confidence takes time and patience and is definitely worth the effort.

One way to help build self-confidence is to focus on a past success. Look at an achievement you are proud of. For example, earning an “A” on your English 101 research paper. Earning that “A” grade involved:

-
-
- Research Skills -using resources to collect the information needed to write the paper
-

Another important factor that can help build your self-confidence is to think about your strengths. Your strengths are generally things that come naturally to you and you do well. For example, some strengths may include:

- Communicating well with others
- Staying calm during a crisis
- Problem solving
- Seeing the silver lining in the midst of chaos

Recognize and reward yourself for the achievements you have accomplished thus far. Give yourself credit for overcoming setbacks and using those situations as opportunities to learn and grow. When things get difficult, it is common to question your abilities. It is times like these when it is necessary to look back at your accomplishments and recognize that you have been successful before and can do it again. Learn from past challenges and how you have conquered them. Focus on the skills you have and the strengths you have developed through previous challenges. Learn from your past successes to help build your future successes.

As you build your self-confidence you will start to feel more in control of your future.

College of the Canyons Student Resources

As you prepare for career success it is also important to take time to acquaint yourself with the services on campus to help you be a successful student. There are many resources on campus to help you pursue your academic and career goals at College of the Canyons. Familiarize yourself with the student support services and identify those you can benefit from. Click [here](#) for a comprehensive list of College of the Canyons Campus Resources & Support Services. Don’t be afraid to ask for help. COC offers many services to help support you on your journey. All you need to do is know what is available to you and how you can benefit from each service.

So far, we have addressed several important factors to get you started on your career journey. Practicing a growth mindset, affirmations and building self-confidence will help guide you through the process of creating your career and life planning vision. Before we begin your journey, let’s take a minute and differentiate between a job and a career.

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2.4: Job vs. Career

Before we dive into the career exploration process, it is important to differentiate between a job and a career. These two terms are often used interchangeably however, they have different meanings.

A **job** is something you would like to have, especially if you want to pay your bills. A job lets you enjoy a minimal level of financial security. A job requires you to show up and do what is required of you; in exchange, you get paid. A job can lead to a career.

A **career** involves an occupation or profession requiring special skills or training; a progression of jobs followed as one's life pursuit. A career involves holding jobs, but it is more a means of achieving personal fulfillment. In a career, your jobs follow a sequence that leads to increasing mastery, professional development, and personal and financial satisfaction. A career requires planning, knowledge, and skills. If it is to be a fulfilling career, it requires that you utilize your full set of analytical, critical, and creative thinking skills to make informed decisions that will affect your life in both the short-term and the long-term.

A career allows you to express your self-concept. Self-Concept is how you see yourself, your own self-awareness of who you are. Donald Super, a psychologist who made great contributions to the field of career counseling, influenced the idea that developing a sense of self and realizing that you change over time is important when planning your career. Self-concept changes over time and develops as a result of experiences. Super's five stages of developmental Self Concept will be discussed in class in greater detail. Refer to the class handout titled "Donald Super's Theory of Developmental Self-concept."

Understanding Super's theory helps provide a framework for your career planning journey. Identify where you are in terms of Super's five life and career development stages and keep this in mind as we continue with self-exploration in unit 2 and answer the question "Who Am I?"

Activity 1.3 – My Job Experience

Think of your current and past work experience, and all the jobs you have held thus far. Consider both paid and unpaid experiences including part-time jobs, volunteer work, and internship experience. Include any leadership roles you may have held as a club officer or part of a sports team.

In your job(s), describe your role(s). What tasks and responsibilities were you accountable for? What skills did you practice in this job? What did you enjoy about this job? What did you not enjoy about this job?

In some cases, a job can help guide you towards your career. Understanding what you like and don't like is a very important part of career and life planning. You may come to find you love one aspect of your job such as helping people and may wish to incorporate that into your future career. Or you may come to learn you did not particularly like trying to persuade clients to purchase a particular item and may learn sales is not your passion. Your past work experience can help you learn a lot about yourself and your future career desires.

Your response to these questions sets the stage for PHASE 1 of the Career Exploration Process and unraveling the question "WHO AM I?" Get ready to engage in self-exploration in the next unit!

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2.5: Your Personal and Career Vision

Envisioning Your Future: Crafting a Career Vision That Inspires You

Where do you imagine yourself 5, 10, 15, even 20 years from now? What kind of life are you working toward—academically, professionally, and personally? Every student in this class has a different picture of the future. Some of you may already see your path with absolute clarity. Others may feel unsure, or even overwhelmed. Most of you will fall somewhere in the middle—and that's completely normal.

No matter where you are on that spectrum, this is the perfect moment to pause and visualize the possibilities ahead. Picture your life in the next decade or two. What will your *ideal* career look like? What kind of person do you hope to become?

As you reflect, consider questions like:

- **What type of work will feel meaningful and give you a sense of accomplishment at the end of the day?**
- **What level of responsibility or leadership do you hope to have?**
- **What work environment will motivate you—collaborative, independent, fast-paced, creative, flexible?**
- **What values do you want reflected in the work you do?**
- **How do you want your career to support your lifestyle, goals, and overall well-being?**

As we begin Unit 2 on **Self-Exploration**, start sketching the mental blueprint of your future. By the end of the semester, this vision will evolve into a clear, thoughtfully crafted **Career Vision Statement**—a personal roadmap that connects who you are now with who you aspire to become.

Career Vision Statements can be incredibly powerful tools. They help you stay grounded during opportunities, challenges, and decisions by reminding you *why* you're working toward your goals. Writing one often takes time, reflection, and multiple revisions, and that's part of the process. As you learn more about your strengths, interests, and values this term, your vision will naturally become sharper and more meaningful.

To help you get started, here are a couple of example Career Vision Statements:

- *"My vision is to become a mental-health advocate and counselor who helps young adults navigate life transitions with confidence, empathy, and resilience."*
- *"I aspire to work in the technology industry as a UX designer, creating products that make life easier and more accessible for communities that are often overlooked."*

Throughout this course, you'll have multiple opportunities to refine and build your own statement, transforming a simple idea into a personalized, inspiring guide for your future.

Career Vision Statement Sample #1:

I will become a well-known and respected leader in the food industry revitalizing the ways food is produced and marketed, making healthier products to help people live better lives.

Career Vision Statement Sample #2:

I will provide the best technical support and customer service to our clients, helping improve their business and lives, striving to solve problems with a positive attitude that spreads to my co-workers.



For more information on creating your career vision visit:

<https://www.livecareer.com/quintessential/vision-statement-samples>

Activity 1.4 – Creating My Career & Life Planning Vision Statement

As you begin PHASE 1 of the career exploration process and answer the question “Who Am I?” start thinking about your personal and career vision. Where do you see yourself in the next few years? What accomplishments do you wish to achieve in your personal and professional life?

Where do you see yourself in the next 5 years....

Where do you see yourself in the next 10 years....

Where do you see yourself in the next 15 years....

Where do you see yourself in the next 20 years....

What will your ideal career look like?

What kind of work is meaningful to you?

What level of responsibility do you desire?

What type of work environment will energize you and give you a sense of purpose?

Reflect on your responses to the questions above and develop your career vision statement here_____

Each phase of the career exploration process will help you refine your career vision statement and solidify it by the end of this course. Enjoy the process!

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2.6: A Journey Begins...

“If you don’t know where you’re going, you might end up somewhere else.”

Yogi Berra might not have been talking about career planning, but he nailed it. College is one of the first big steps toward a life you actually want—work that feels exciting, meaningful, and *you*.

How the job world is changing—and what it means for you

1. You won’t just have one job... you’ll have many.

Gone are the days when people worked for one company their whole career. According to the U.S. Department of Labor, the average person holds nearly eleven jobs between ages 18 and 42. That means your best strategy is to develop *transferable skills*—things like communication, problem-solving, teamwork, and tech literacy that you can use anywhere.

2. Your future job might not even exist yet.

Technology evolves fast, and global priorities change just as quickly. Five years ago, hardly anyone had heard of “SEO specialists.” Now they’re everywhere. Fields like elder care, homeland security, biotech, and nanotech exploded because of new needs and innovations. Translation: to stay competitive, you’ll need to be a lifelong learner.

3. Work is no longer tied to one place.

Unless you’re working with specialized equipment or directly with customers, many jobs can now be done from anywhere with Wi-Fi. Employers want people who can work independently, stay organized, and deliver results without someone constantly checking in.

4. Online job applications = huge competition.

Posting jobs online makes it easy for companies to reach applicants—and easy for applicants (like you) to reach companies. But it also means your resume may be one of hundreds in a hiring manager’s inbox. Standing out with strong skills, a clear personal brand, and smart application strategies is essential.

Today’s career landscape is way more dynamic than it used to be—but that’s actually exciting. You have the chance to carve out a path that fits *you*, not some outdated idea of what a career should look like. Stay flexible, keep learning, use technology to your advantage, and focus on developing real, demonstrable skills.

Your career won’t be linear—but it can absolutely be amazing.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Exploring Options

Learning Objectives

- Use valuable career assessments to help you gain a better understanding of yourself and visualize where you fit best in the world of work.
- Define and clarify your values and how they relate to your career choices.
- Identify your own personality type and how your preferences connect to choice of major and career.
- Distinguish your interests, confirm your skills, and character strengths and link them to potential major and career choices.

[3.1: Getting Started With Careers Assessments](#)

[3.2: Values](#)

[3.3: Myers-Briggs Type Indicator \(MBTI\)](#)

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3.1: Getting Started With Careers Assessments

Discovering Who You Are

Before you can decide what career path to take, you first have to understand **yourself**. How can you know what career will make you happy if you don't know what drives you, inspires you, and challenges you?

In this unit, you'll complete several **career assessments** designed to help you explore your **personality, values, interests, and motivations**. These tools aren't about putting you in a box — they're about giving you insight into who you are, what you're good at, and what kind of work environment will allow you to thrive. You'll begin to see patterns and connections between your natural strengths and potential career paths that fit your unique personality.

The first step in your career journey is asking yourself a powerful question:

“Who am I?”

This question sets the foundation for your entire career exploration process. Take time to dig deep and think about:

- What motivates you to get up in the morning?
- What activities make you feel energized and fulfilled?
- What tasks do you dread or find draining?
- What environments help you perform your best — and which ones don't?
- What are your natural strengths, and what new skills can you develop to stay competitive?



Your honest answers to these questions will help guide you toward what we call “**Meaningful Work.**”

Remember: **no assessment can ever know you better than you know yourself**. These tools are meant to guide you — not define you. Use them to make sense of your past experiences, highlight your strengths, and uncover new directions you may not have considered before.

Stay curious, keep an open mind, and don't be afraid to explore areas that feel uncertain or unfamiliar. The more effort you invest in self-discovery, the more confident you'll feel when making decisions about your future. This journey is not just about choosing a career — it's about learning who you are and what kind of life you want to build.

So dive in, stay engaged, and most importantly — **enjoy the process**. Your future starts with getting to know *you*.

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3.2: Values

Values are the characteristics that are most important to you. They make up your core belief system and serve as motivators that guide you in what you do and decisions you make. It is important to consider your values as you select a career. You will enjoy the work you do more if it aligns with your core values. If the work you choose conflicts with your values, you will most likely struggle with the position and this may create tension and discomfort in your life. It is important to consider your personal values along with your work related values.

For example, if you value good health and are assigned to market a product that may cause serious health concerns, you will likely find it difficult to market this item. If you are asked to do this on a continual basis, you will internally struggle with the role you play as this job forces you to go against your core values.

Let's Take a Look at Work Values

According to the [Occupational Information Network \(O*NET\)](https://www.onetonline.org/), the nation's primary source of occupational information, work values are defined as the “global aspects of work that are important to a person's satisfaction.” Below is a screenshot of the six work values to take into consideration while researching career options. O*NET allows you to do a [Work Values Search](https://www.onetonline.org/explore/workvalues/Achievement/) by entering your top three Work Values to see which occupations match your choices.



Figure 2.2 – Browse by O*Net Data (Screenshot from https://www.onetonline.org/find/descriptor/browse/Work_Values/)

You will have an opportunity to complete a values assessment activity in class using the values card sort along with other online resources such as:

- Work Values Search through O*NET: this assessment allows you to match your chosen work values with occupations that match. <https://www.onetonline.org/explore/workvalues/Achievement/>
- Kuder Journey: an online tool, which provides reliable inventories to assess your interests, skills confidence, and work values, and suggests occupations and majors that match your assessment results. Kuder Journey also includes resources like a resume builder and online portfolio, to prepare you for the job search and connect you to today's jobs! Your instructor will distribute login instructions with an activation code. You will have the opportunity to take the three assessments: interests, skills confidence, and work values.
- Work Importance Profiler: this assessment helps you determine what values are important to you and how they line up with different careers. To complete the Work Importance Profiler go to the California Career Zone site at: <https://www.cacareerzone.org/wip/>. Below is a screenshot.

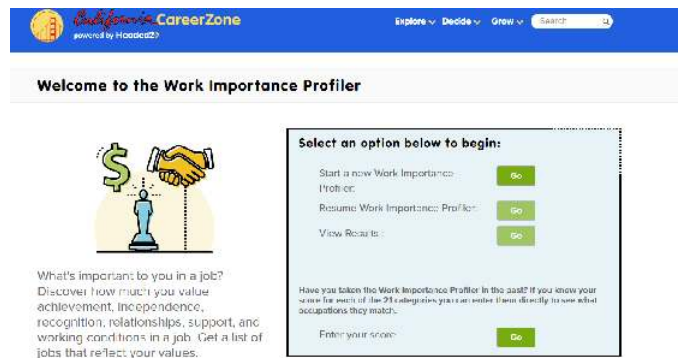


Figure 2.3 –California Career Zone (Screenshot from <https://www.cacareerzone.org/wip/>).

Your values will play an important role in each phase of the career and life planning process; therefore, it is important to take time to assess what is most important to you. When your values align with the work you do, you will feel more satisfied and invested in your career.

Activity 2.1 – Identify Your Work Values⁵

Complete the following three activities to review the work values that are most important to you.

1. Read about [six core work values](#) developed by the U.S. Department of Labor's O*NET program. Click on the ones that best describe you to see careers that highlight that value. Record your findings:
2. The Values Card Sort Activity:

Your instructor may have you participate in this activity in class if you are taking an on ground/face to face class. If you are completing this course online, you may do it yourself by downloading and printing O*NET's [work values cards](#) (pdf). Cut your own cards and sort them into three piles, identifying whether each is “essential,” “important,” or “not important” for your career needs. Make a note of the values that ranked high for you. Record your findings:

3. Take the California [CareerZone Work Importance Profiler](#) and get a list of jobs that reflect your values. Record your findings:

After you have identified your top values, explore careers that would allow you to express your values. Do you see a common theme amongst these careers? Explain:

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3.3: Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

The Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a personality assessment that was developed by Katherine Briggs and her daughter Isabel Briggs Myers based on the framework of personality theory by Carl C. Jung. The MBTI is a personality assessment that measures the psychological preferences that influence how people perceive the world and make decisions. This assessment is widely used across the world and has been translated into two dozen plus languages. Many companies use the MBTI with their staff to help employees learn more about themselves and how they can strengthen their department team efforts and increase overall productivity for the company. Many colleges and universities use the MBTI to help with career exploration.

The MBTI will help you gain a better understanding of your preferences and work environments that best fit you. The MBTI does *not* measure abilities, skills, values or interests. It assesses your personality preferences. The MBTI instrument indicates preferences on four pairs of opposites called dichotomies.⁶

Watch the following video to get an introduction of four facets that comprise the 16 possible personality types.



Figure 2.5 – Watch “Discover Your Personality Type | Myers Briggs” (link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=7&v=WQoOqQiVzwQ).

Personality Theory: The 4 Facets⁷

- Extroversion-Introversion (EI): how you get your energy and where you prefer to focus your attention
- Sensing-Intuition (SN): how you take in information about the world around you
- Thinking-Feeling (TF): how you like to make decisions
- Judging-Perceiving (JP): how you prefer to organize your life

These four preferences make up your type, which results in 16 rich, complex, highly differentiated whole types. You will have an opportunity in class to self-identify your preferences and this will be your “**Self-estimated**” type. Your instructor will give you more information on taking the MBTI personality assessment.

Once the assessment is completed, your instructor will generate a career report and distribute your results to you. The results of this assessment will be your “**Reported**” type. After learning more about the MBTI and reviewing your self-estimated type and your reported type, you will confirm your “**Best-fit**” type. This will be addressed in more detail in class.

Activity 2.3 – What’s Your Type?⁸

Read descriptions for the four facets. Pick which is more like you.

- E (Extraversion) or I (Introversion)?
- S (Sensing) or N? (Intuition)?
- T (Thinking) or F? (Feeling)?
- J (Judging) or P? (Perceiving)?

Could be described as:

- Talkative, outgoing
- Like to be in a fast-paced environment
- Tend to work out ideas with other, think aloud
- Enjoy being the center of attention

Then you prefer
(E) Extraversion

Could be described as:

- Reserved, private
- Prefer a slower pace with time for contemplation
- Tend to think things through inside your head
- Would rather observe then be the center of attention

Then you prefer
(I) Introversion

Could be described as:

- Focus on the reality of how things are
- Pay attention to concrete facts and details
- Prefer ideas that have practical applications
- Like to describe things in a specific, literal way

Then you prefer
(S) Sensing

Could be described as:

- Imagine the possibilities of how things could be
- Notice the big picture, see how everything connects
- Enjoy ideas and concepts for their own sake
- Like to be describe in a way figurative, poetic

Then you prefer
(N) Intuition

Could be described as:

- Make decision in an impersonal way, using logical reasoning
- Value justice, fairness
- Enjoy finding the flaws in an arguments
- Could be described as reasonable, level-headed

Then you prefer
(T) Thinking

Could be described as:

- Base you decision on personal values and how our actions affect others
- Value harmony, forgiveness
- Like to please others and point out the best in people
- Could be described as warm empathetic

Then you prefer
(F) Feeling

Could be described as:

- Prefer to have matters settled
- Think rules and deadlines should be respected
- Prefer to have a detailed step-by-step instructions
- Make plans, want to know what you're getting into

Then you prefer
(J) Judging

Could be described as:

- Prefer to leave your options open
- See rules and deadlines as flexible
- Like to improvise and make things up as you go
- Are spontaneous, enjoy surprise and new situations

Then you prefer
(P)Perceiving

What is your 4-letter personality type? _ _ _ _

The following are brief descriptions of the 16 personality types from [Humanmetrics](https://socialsci.libretexts.org/@page/307521). Click on your personality type or a similar type to see which describes you best.

ESTJ	ISTJ	ENTJ	INTJ
ESTP	ISTP	ENTP	INTP
ESFJ	ISFJ	ENFJ	INFJ
ESFP	ISFP	ENFP	INFP

Each type is unique and presents its own strengths and challenges. No one type is better than the other. Any type can do anything if motivated!

Your instructor will generate your career report based on your responses to the online MBTI assessment. The career report will help you:

- Identify job families or broad occupational categories to help you get started in your career search.
- Choose a specific job or career.
- Select a college major or course of study.
- Identify strengths and potential weaknesses of your type for the career search process.
- Increase your job satisfaction.
- Make a career transition or shift.
- Plan your career development strategy and action steps.

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3.4: John Holland's classifications of work environments

Video Transcript: RIASEC at Work Matching Your Personality to Career⁹



Figure 2.6 – Watch “RIASEC at Work Matching Your Personality to Career” (Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N3vjopNT4V8>).

(Transcript) Work, it's a hard fact of life. Sometimes just finding work we enjoy and are good at is challenge enough. Some people spend their entire life searching for the right job. Many don't know where to even start looking.

In the United States alone, there are more than a hundred and fifty million people working thousands of different kinds of jobs. From accountants to athletes. From dancers to dentists. From teachers to top executives. Every job requires its own set of skills and comes with its own rigors and rewards. And just as not everybody is right for every job, not every job is right for everybody. In fact, your personality, those characteristics, traits and preferences that make you who you are, is a major factor in determining which occupations are right for you. People who follow career paths that match their personalities are more likely to be both satisfied and successful with those careers. This video will introduce you to one of the best ways to find work that fits with your personality. It's called the RIASEC personality theory and it is a time-tested tool for exploring and deciding on a career that's right for you. You'll learn how the tasks and work environments of jobs match with personality types and even learn which jobs tend to be a better fit for each type. Along the way, you may discover careers that match your own interests, perhaps leading to greater career satisfaction down the road. So, let's get started.

In the 1950s, renowned psychologist John L. Holland developed a theory and a process that helped individuals match their work interests, otherwise known as their vocational personalities, to their preferred work environments. Holland's theory says that most people can be described by one or more of six personality types: realistic, investigative, artistic, social, enterprising and conventional. People who share the same personality type tend to group together and create work environments with shared values. What does this mean? In short, people who work in an environment that is a good fit for their personality type and with people who share their interests and personality traits are more likely to find satisfaction and success in their career. What Holland did was to give us a way to view the world of work from forty thousand feet, plus a quick way to take stock of our abilities and preferences so we can really understand where we fit in best. If you were to consider all the hundreds of possible career choices, you might be overwhelmed by the task of narrowing down your options. The Holland personality types simplify this process by helping you to make a quick first cut.

The terms that Holland invented for personality types may be a little puzzling when you first encounter them. What do you mean, I'm not realistic? But once you learn what they mean, you'll find they provide real insights into yourself and your career choices. But which personality type or types best describe you? Are you the kind of person who likes to help others? Are you a risk taker who is always looking for a new business opportunity? Do you prefer to work with your hands or with ideas? Indoors or out? In groups or by yourself? Knowing your answers to these and other questions about work preferences can help you to discover your vocational interests and, thus, the kind of work that will fit your best. It's important to realize that most people have a variety of interests and most of us can't be pigeonholed into just one personality type. Usually it helps if we think in terms of a primary type that describes us best, plus one or two secondary types that reflect other interests we have. For example, you might have primarily realistic interests but also have investigative or conventional interests. Your work may not satisfy all of your interests, that's why we have hobbies, but once you have an understanding of your dominant personality type or types, you can identify work situations where you'll fit in best.

Keep in mind that just as people are varied, work situations are too. A particular career might combine aspects that are attractive to, for example, social and enterprising personality types. Also, remember that it's not a good thing for everybody in a certain career to be exactly alike. You may have heard of something called group think, which happens when there's no diversity in the workplace. In fact, in most workplaces you'll find a variety of people but they will share a core of certain interests and preferences that drew them to this kind of work. That's what the Holland types are designed to describe. The rest of this video will better introduce you to the six Holland personality types. You'll learn about the interests and values that characterize each personality type as well as specific jobs whose work situations cater to those interests and values. As you progress through this video, think about the kinds of work that you enjoy or might enjoy. Don't worry about fitting yourself into one personality type. Keep your options open. But if one or more of the six types interests you or seems to match your personal characteristics, pay close attention to the jobs that go with that type. Who knows, one of those may be the job of your dreams.¹⁰



(Holland Codes by QVhighschool01 is licensed under CC BY-SA 3.0)

You will have an opportunity to complete the Strong Interest Inventory in class. Your instructor will give you more detailed information on completing this assessment. Once you complete the assessment, your instructor will generate a career report and distribute your results to you.

Read over the different RIASEC work environments below and consider your first, second and third choice interests.

- **Realistic:** These people describe themselves as honest, loyal, and practical. They are doers more than thinkers. They have strong mechanical, motor, and athletic abilities; like the outdoors; and prefer working with machines, tools, plants, and animals.¹¹ Realistic occupations frequently involve work activities that include practical, hands-on problems and solutions. They often deal with plants, animals, and real-world materials like wood, tools, and machinery. Many of the occupations require working outside, and do not involve a lot of paperwork or working closely with others.
- **Investigative:** These people love problem solving and analytical skills. They are intellectually stimulated and often mathematically or scientifically inclined; like to observe, learn, and evaluate; prefer working alone; and are reserved.¹² Investigative occupations frequently involve working with ideas, and require an extensive amount of thinking. These occupations can involve searching for facts and figuring out problems mentally.
- **Artistic:** These people are the “free spirits.” They are creative, emotional, intuitive, and idealistic; have a flair for communicating ideas; dislike structure and prefer working independently; and like to sing, write, act, paint, and think creatively. They are similar to the investigative type but are interested in the artistic and aesthetic aspects of things more than the scientific.¹³ Artistic occupations frequently involve working with forms, designs and patterns. They often require self-expression and the work can be done without following a clear set of rules.
- **Social:** These are “people” people. They are friendly and outgoing; love to help others, make a difference, or both; have strong verbal and personal skills and teaching abilities; and are less likely to engage in intellectual or physical activity.¹⁴ Social occupations frequently involve working with, communicating with, and teaching people. These occupations often involve helping or providing service to others.
- **Enterprising:** These people are confident, assertive risk takers. They are sociable; enjoy speaking and leadership; like to persuade rather than guide; like to use their influence; have strong interpersonal skills; and are status conscious.¹⁵ Enterprising occupations frequently involve starting up and carrying out projects. These occupations can involve leading people and making many decisions. Sometimes they require risk taking and often deal with business.

- **Conventional:** These people are dependable, detail oriented, disciplined, precise, persistent, and practical; value order; and are good at clerical and numerical tasks. They work well with people and data, so they are good organizers, schedulers, and project managers.¹⁶ Conventional occupations frequently involve following set procedures and routines. These occupations can include working with data and details more than with ideas. Usually there is a clear line of authority to follow.

Activity 2.4 – What’s Your Occupational Type¹⁷

Using the descriptions above, choose the three types that most closely describe you and list them in order in the following table. Most people are combinations of two or sometimes three types. Then list the specific words or attributes that you feel describe you best. After determining your primary, secondary, and tertiary occupational types, take the first initial for each type, in order, to establish your occupational code.

Occupational Type	Word and Attributes That Closely Describe Me
Primary type (the one I identify with most closely)	
Secondary type	
Tertiary type	

Note: Your occupational code is made up of the initials of the three personality types you selected, in order.

My occupational code: ____ ____ ____

(For example: if Social, Enterprising, and Conventional are your top three occupational types, your occupational code would be: S E C)

Exploring Careers and Your Occupational Type

Now that you have determined your top three occupational types, you can begin to explore the types of careers that may be best suited for you. Holland studied people who were successful and happy in many occupations and matched their occupations to their occupational type, creating a description of the types of occupations that are best suited to each personality type. Just as many individuals are more than one personality type, many jobs show a strong correlation to more than one occupational type.

This is a rough beginning to finding your occupational type, but you will soon be seeking out more detailed results from the Strong Interest Inventory assessment as a part of this course.

Use the top three occupation types you defined in the exercise, “What’s Your Occupational Type?” to help identify careers you may want to consider from the table below.

Table 2.1 – Occupational Options by Type¹⁸

Type	Ideal Environments	Sample Occupations
Realistic	• Structured • Clear lines of authority • Work with things and tools • Casual dress • Focus on tangible results or well-thought-out goals	• Contractor • Emergency medical technician (EMT) • Mechanic • Military career • Packaging engineer
Investigative	• Nonstructured • Research oriented • Intellectual • Work with ideas and data	• Pharmacist • Lab technician • Nanotechnologist • Geologist • College professor
Artistic	• Nonstructured • Creative • Rewards unconventional and aesthetic approaches • Creation of products and ideas	• Collaborative • Collegial • Work with people and on people-related problems/issues • Work as a team or community

Social	• Collaborative • Collegial • Work with people and on people-related problems/issues • Work as a team or community	• Teacher • Geriatric counselor • Correctional officer • Coach • Nurse
Enterprising	• Typical business environment • Results oriented • Driven • Work with people and data • Entrepreneurial • Power focused	• Sales manager • Banker • Lawyer • Business owner • Restaurant manager
Conventional	• Orderly • Clear rules and policies • Consistent processes • Work with systems to manipulate and organize data • Control and handling of money	• Auditor • Insurance underwriter • Bank teller • Office manager • Database manager

You can use the Department of Labor's O*Net (<http://online.onetcenter.org/find>) to get a deeper understanding of your occupation. For each occupation, O*Net lists the type of work, the work environment, the skills and education required, and the job outlook for that occupation. This is a truly rich resource that you should get to know.

You will have the opportunity to complete an interest assessment using one of the following online resources:

- Careeronestop: <http://www.careeronestop.org/ExploreCareers/assessments/self-assessments.aspx> (go to "Interest Assessment")
- O*NET Interest Profiler: <https://www.mynextmove.org/explore/ip>
- . Your results will give you a great deal of information to help you make informed decisions about your future including:
 - careers that reflect your interest
 - possible education and training programs
 - satisfying work environments
 - enjoyable activities for your free time

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3.5: Skills

Skilled Labor

Employers seek skills. Many of the skills you will need are career specific: we call those specific skills **hard skills** or **technical skills**. These include knowing how to use equipment that is specific to your career and mastering processes that are used in your field. While some of these skills are learned and perfected on the job, you may be in a vocational track program (such as for homeland security officers, nurses, aides, or paralegals) where you are learning your technical skills.

These are not the only skills you will need to be successful. The second set of skills you must have are called soft skills or transferable skills, which contribute to success in any number of occupations because they can be used in almost all occupations. Some soft skills include thinking skills, communication skills, listening skills and leadership skills. This skill set is very broad, and your extent of mastery will vary from skill to skill; therefore, you should identify those skills that are most important to your career objective and develop and master them. Search on O*Net (<http://online.onetcenter.org/find>) to determine which skills you need to demonstrate to potential employers you have mastered based on your career interest.

Employers want individuals who have the necessary hard and soft skills to do the job well and adapt to changes in the workplace. Soft skills may be especially in demand today because employers are generally equipped to train new employees in a hard skill—by training them to use new computer software, for instance—but it's much more difficult to teach an employee a soft skill such as developing rapport with coworkers or knowing how to manage conflict. An employer might rather hire an inexperienced worker who can pay close attention to details than an experienced worker who might cause problems on a work team.

In this section, you will look at ways of identifying and building particular hard and soft skills that will be necessary for your career path.¹⁹

Table 2.2 - Transferable Skills Inventory

Active listening	Decision making	Negotiating	Researching
Active learning	Editing	Observing	Selling
Analyzing	Evaluating	Organizing	Speaking a 2 nd language
Budgeting	Forecasting	Perceiving Feelings	Supervising
Coaching	Goal setting	Persuading	Teaching
Communicating	Handling a crisis	Planning	Teamwork
Consulting	Handling details	Problem solving	Time management
Creative thinking	Manipulating numbers	Public speaking	Training
Critical thinking	Mentoring	Reading	Visualizing
Customer service	Motivating	Reporting	Writing

These skills are transferable because they are positive attributes that are invaluable in practically any kind of work. They also do not require much training from an employer—you have them already and take them with you wherever you go. Transferable/Soft skills are a big part of your “total me” package.

So, identify the transferable/soft skills that show you off the best, and identify the ones that prospective employers are looking for. By comparing both sets, you can more directly gear your job search to your strongest professional qualities.

You will have the opportunity to complete skills assessments using different online resources such as:

- Kuder Journey: an online tool, which provides reliable inventories to assess your interests, skills confidence, and work values, and suggests occupations and majors that match your assessment results. Kuder Journey also includes resources like a resume builder and online portfolio, to prepare you for the job search and connect you to today's jobs! Your instructor will distribute login instructions and you will have the opportunity to take the three assessments: interests, skills confidence, and work values.
- Skills Matcher: an online “Skills Assessment” through [Careeronestop](#). The Skills Matcher helps you identify your skills. Use the Skills Matcher to create a list of your skills and match them to careers that use those skills. Click here to complete the Skills

Matcher: <https://www.careeronestop.org/toolkit/Skills/skills-matcher.aspx>

- Skills Profiler listed under the “Assess Yourself” heading.

21st Century Skills

Due to the rapid changes in the global economy and the advancement of technology, the workplace has changed dramatically. As a student it is important for you to gain the knowledge and skills employers are seeking. To help train the new generation entering the workforce, a team of educators came together with employers, workforce development boards, and research organizations across the country to build college/career-ready, 21st Century Employability Skills Program called [New World of Work \(NWoW\) 21st Century Skills Training](#).²⁰



Figure 2.8 – Watch “Part 1 21st Century Skills” (link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RIT34HJbXA>)

[New World of Work \(NWoW\)](#) was developed under the [Doing What MATTERS for Jobs and the Economy](#) framework of the California Community Colleges system, which is the largest higher education system in the nation with 72 districts and 115 colleges serving over 2.1 million students each year.

Starting in 2012, the New World of Work team began tracking futurist projections, economic reports, and national research related to the correlation between education and employment.

The group conducted a series of Skills Panels to gather feedback from employers, entrepreneurs, human resources specialists, educators, and students to determine the essential employability skills required in our emerging global economy.

From the research gathered, NWoW established their “Top 10” list of 21st Century Employability Skills. They worked closely with expert curriculum developers, including the NWoW Co-Creators, video crews, college faculty across disciplines, and digital badging teams then created lessons and badges to go along with each of the skills.

They identified the following “Top 10” list of 21st Century Employability Skills:



Figure 2.9 – Essential 21st Century Skills (Image by [New World of Work](#) is licensed under [CC BY-NC-SA 3.0](#))

For more information about NWoW, read the [Executive Summary](#) report titled “Community Colleges and 21st Century Skills: Skills Panels to Assist Student Career Success”²¹

What is a Digital Badge?

Preview the short video by the MacArthur Foundation to get an overview of what a Digital Badge is and how it can be used.

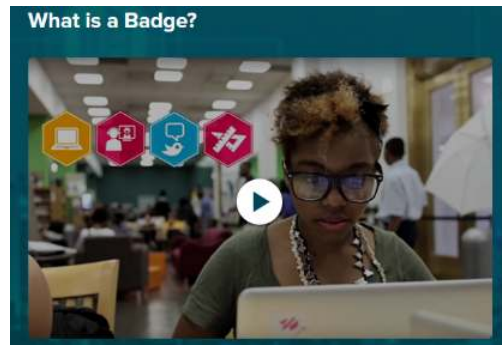


Figure 2.10 – Watch “What is a Badge” (link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RDmfE0noOJ8>).

The New World of Work awards “Learner Badges” for all 10 of the 21st Century Skills. This is available to you for FREE! The NWoW Learner Badges are based on the NWoW High School/opportunity youth video series paired with multiple-choice questions. These can be used with high school, post secondary, adult learners or the general public to provide an introduction to the 21st Century Skills and the process for earning badges. Assessment pages launch directly from [NWoW website](#) by clicking on the Learner Badge icons. Below is a screenshot of the Learner Badges series.



Figure 2.11 – 21st Century Skills Learner Badges (Image by New World of Work is licensed under [CC BY-NC-SA 3.0](#))

. The Career Skills Courses offered through Continuing Education are FREE and available in an on ground and online format to meet the needs of diverse learners and all courses are open to the community! Completing the Career Skills training is a great way to show employers you are equipped with the skills necessary to be successful in today's workforce and allows you to earn digital badges you may post on your LinkedIn and social media profile.

One other benefit of the NWoW – 21st Century Skills Curriculum, is the **LinkedIn Crosswalk**, that provides the following:

- Partnership with LinkedIn to provide suggested next steps after each skill lesson
- Instructors and students can utilize the LinkedIn Learning/Lynda.com videos that have been crosswalked with NWoW skills to take a deeper dive into the traits of that skill
- Completion of these video courses generates certificates that can be hosted on LinkedIn profiles along with skills badges, school/alumni information.
- Also, Career Education students at COC who participate in the Continuing Education FREE Career Skills courses receive free Lynda.com access.

View the YouTube PBS News Hour video titled " Giving students a leg up with job skills a resume won't show" to learn more about digital badges and how they can help you be more marketable.



Figure 2.10 – Watch “Giving students a leg up with job skills a resume won’t show” (link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KGdHNtLlrg>)

Activity 2.5 – Identifying Your Skills²²

Self-identify your Top 5 transferable (soft) skills, skills you are good at, and those skills you wish to learn or develop further. Review the list of transferable skills list and additional checklist of transferable skills above to complete the chart below. Describe specific ways in which you have used each skill successfully. This will come in handy when we discuss interviewing strategies. Consider skills important to your career that you have not yet mastered and how you plan to master them. Give examples

Number	Top 5 Skills I Enjoy Using	Top 5 Skills that Come Naturally	Top 5 Skills that I Want to Learn
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

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